

ADVANCE GOOGLE DORKING

INTRODUCTION:

In the field of cybersecurity, gathering information from public sources plays a crucial role in identifying security risks. **Google Dorking**, also known as **Google Hacking**, is a powerful technique that uses advanced search operators to find hidden data and exposed resources on websites. This report explains Google Dorking, useful search operators, and its importance in penetration testing and ethical hacking.

1. What is Google Dorking?

Google Dorking, also known as Google Hacking, is a technique used to extract sensitive information from publicly available resources using advanced Google search operators. By crafting specific search queries, attackers or security researchers can uncover exposed directories, login pages, confidential files, and other sensitive data that may not appear in general searches.

In cybersecurity, Google Dorking is considered a part of OSINT (Open Source Intelligence), as it relies on publicly accessible information indexed by Google. While it's a valuable tool for ethical hackers and penetration testers during reconnaissance, it can also be misused for malicious purposes.

Key Points:

- Uses advanced search operators to filter Google search results.
- Helps security professionals discover unintentionally exposed sensitive data.
- Can uncover files like passwords, configuration files, backups, etc.
- Part of OSINT techniques, utilizing publicly available data.
- Considered a legal technique when used ethically and responsibly.

2. List of Useful Google Dorks and Their Uses

Dork/Operator	Use
site:example.com	Search results from a specific website.
intitle:"index of"	Find open directory listings.
filetype:pdf	Find PDF files.
filetype:xls	Find Excel files.
inurl:admin	Find admin login pages.
inurl:login	Find login portals.
ext:sql	Search for exposed SQL files.
cache:example.com	View cached version of a site.
related:example.com	Find related websites.
"confidential"	Find pages containing sensitive keywords.
intitle:"phpmyadmin"	Locate phpMyAdmin panels.
filetype:log	Locate log files.
filetype:env	Search for exposed environment files.
allintext:password	Pages containing the word password.
intext:"index of /backup"	Find backup folders.
intitle:"login"	Finds login pages by title.
intitle:"signup"	Finds sign-up pages.
filetype:sql	Finds exposed SQL database files.
filetype:conf	Finds configuration files.

Dork/Operator

filetype:bak

filetype:xml

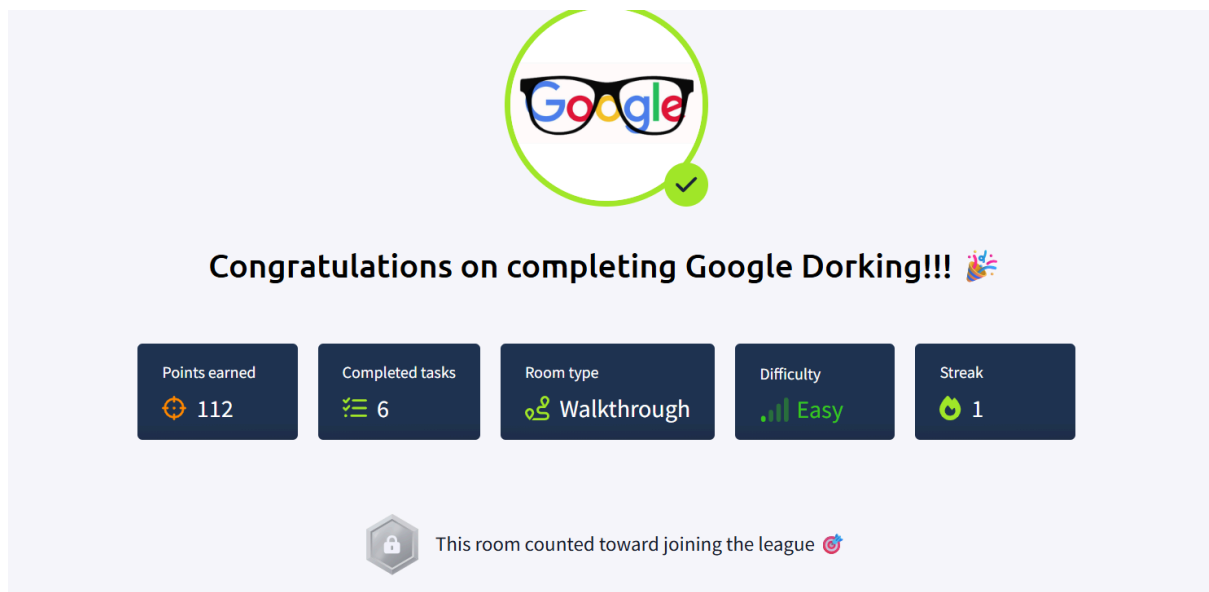
Use

Finds backup files.

Finds XML files (can include sensitive data).

3. Practical – TryHackMe Google Dorking Room

I've completed the practical learning through TryHackMe's **Google Dorking Room**:



CONCLUSION:

It is an essential skill for ethical hackers and penetration testers, allowing them to discover sensitive information using simple yet powerful search queries. It helps in identifying exposed files, hidden directories, login portals, and potential vulnerabilities that are publicly accessible but often overlooked. By

mastering advanced search operators, cybersecurity professionals can strengthen their reconnaissance phase and perform more efficient vulnerability assessments. However, it should always be used responsibly and within legal boundaries, as it involves accessing publicly available but sensitive data.